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Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation (CMHC)

Re: Principal, Software Engineering (Ottawa, ON / Montréal, QC — Hybrid)

Dear Hiring Committee,

I'm writing to express interest in the Principal, Software Engineering role at CMHC. Over 18 years in DevOps and platform engineering, the pattern that has defined my career is being handed a narrow, specific ask and delivering something structurally larger — fixing the root cause of a problem instead of patching around it. That's close to the core of what this role asks for: setting engineering standards and reducing technical debt across multiple agile teams, not just executing tickets.

At Énergir, I standardized CI/CD delivery across nine distinct runtimes for 12 application teams and 70+ applications, and drove that adoption through recurring enablement sessions outside any formal reporting line — turning delivered tooling into actual practice rather than shelfware. When asked to port legacy Salesforce deployment scripts, I replaced them with the official Salesforce CLI tooling and built a validation-sandbox gate that made a bad deployment structurally unable to reach production, cutting missed deployment windows from a recurring problem to a single miss since launch. I bring that same instinct to standards and technical debt: the goal isn't compliance for its own sake, it's making the right practice the path of least resistance.

On the technical side, I've led cloud modernization migrating 5–10 mission-critical services to Microsoft Azure, and built hands-on Kubernetes automation at my most recent engagement with Desjardins — provisioning on-demand instances for safe configuration testing — directly relevant to CMHC's cloud-native platform stack. I'm fully bilingual, French native and English fluent, which I understand is required at the CBC level for this role.

I'd welcome the opportunity to discuss how this experience applies to CMHC's engineering organization. Thank you for your consideration.

Best regards,

Marc Berthelette